

EXPERIMENTER RUN SHEET

Follow My Voice

Gaze-contingent XR search
with a self-similar agent

Setting	Seated, rotating mixed-reality object search
Voice comparison	Generic and self-similar; within participant
Hardware	HTC Vive Focus Vision
Source version	Run sheet v0.1, September 16, 2026
Styled edition	September 20, 2026

Protocol proposal | Review and rehearsal

The following pages preserve the current run sheet. Source wording is retained. The first block still specifies 24 rounds and the second 30 valid attempts, while the latest provisional plan is 30 experimental trials per voice. The second-block script also assumes self-similar voice despite counterbalanced order. Reconcile these before participant use. This edition does not establish study approval or participant readiness.

Gaze Contingency Search Study

Experimenter Run Sheet

Version: 0.1 | September 16 2026 | Protocol proposal for rehearsal and review. The IRB application has not been submitted. Use with the approved consent and finalized study settings before participant collection.

Researcher only: Two counterbalanced voice blocks, generic and self-similar. Both use gaze-contingent warmer/colder guidance. Planned trial start is the same fixed front direction. Say “first block” and “second block”; do not suggest that either voice should improve performance.

Session record: Participant ID _____ Run _____ Date _____ Researcher _____ Build _____
Voice order _____ Neutral profile _____ Survey version _____

Before participant arrives

- Sanitize and test the Head Mounted Display (HMD) and controllers.
- Open Unity and Qualtrics.
- Enter coded ID and assigned condition.
- Prepare consent, baseline survey, both block surveys, final interview and session/event record. Use one defined TLX collection route; see the beta note in Section 7.

1 Welcome and consent

Say: “Thank you for coming. You will stay seated and turn to find virtual objects by their color and shape. A voice assistant will provide hints. You may pause, take a break or stop at any time without penalty.”

Say: “We will ask you to record a short voice sample to create a synthetic version of your voice. We also record eye-gaze and task data under a study code. Please read the consent form for what is collected, where it is processed and how it is handled.”

ACTION: Obtain consent.

2 Initial Qualtrics

Say: “Please complete the background and current-comfort questions before we begin. Use only the study code already entered. Do not add your name or contact details. You may skip optional questions.”

ACTION: Confirm coded ID and baseline symptom record. Apply approved screening rules. Record missing responses without inventing answers. Survey platform and exact form must match the session record.

3 Fit and calibrate the headset

Say: “Remain seated in this chair. You may turn the chair, your body and your head to look around, but do not stand or walk. Tell me immediately if you feel dizzy, nauseated, strained, uncomfortable or unsteady.”

ACTION: Fit equipment and verify tracking.

Ask: “Can you see clearly? Does the equipment feel comfortable? Do you feel well enough to continue?”

4 Record and prepare the voices

Say: “First, I will explain the task. You will hear a target color and shape, then search the objects around you. Hold your gaze on the matching object to select it. The voice may give warmer or colder guidance. Reading the passage is for voice preparation, not a scored search trial.”

Say: “Read the displayed passage in your natural voice after the tone. Do not say your name or add personal information. When you finish, select Finish recording.”

Say: “We will now connect a short sample of your voice, after the tone please read the script.” Then “Processing voice.” When ready: “Voice setup is ready. Let’s check the audio.”

ACTION: Keep the headset active during preparation and verify both voice playback samples before accepting readiness. “Ready” means starter clips are prepared; the remaining library loads in the background. Do not continue after failed preparation or substitute the generic voice for a failed self-similar condition.

5 Familiarization

ACTION: At the 360 search start checkpoint, seat the participant at the intended center facing the chosen room-front reference. Release the trigger, then press Trigger / Enter to center and begin. Record the reference; do not recenter to wherever the participant happens to face later.

Say: “Objects will appear on eight areas around you. Find the object with the announced color and shape. Turn while staying seated, then hold your gaze on the matching object until it is selected. You do not need to count rounds.”

Say: “The next rounds are practice. They do not count toward the measured task, although the system may still log them. Use this time to learn how to search and select an object.”

ACTION: Allow the user to complete the object selection practice rounds.

Ask: “Do you have any questions about the controls or task?”

Say: “When you are ready, we will begin the first task block.”

6 First task block

INTERNAL SETTINGS Practice | Real | 24 rounds

Researcher settings: Confirm the saved first voice and planned trial schedule. Keep object layout, selection method, guidance policy and the finalized prompt wording constant across voices.

Say: “We will now begin the first task block. Find each target as quickly and accurately as you comfortably can. Stay seated and use the same gaze selection you practiced. Tell me if you need to pause.”

ACTION: Start block; monitor safety.

At completion say: “That task block is complete. Please stop and lower your hands comfortably.”

Say: “These questions ask about your workload, your experience of the activity and the voice assistant. There are no right answers. Please answer based on the block you just finished.”

ACTION: Administer Survey Block #1.

Say: “You may take a short break of up to about a minute and a half. Tell me when you are ready to continue.”

Before continuing ask: “Do you feel comfortable and well enough to continue?”

Second Task Block

INTERNAL SETTINGS | Assigned condition | 30 valid attempts

READ ONLY THE ASSIGNED CONDITION SCRIPT:

Say: “We will now begin the second task block. The task and selection method are the same. Find each target as quickly and accurately as you comfortably can, and tell me if you need to pause. This block will use your self-similar voice.”

ACTION: Start block; monitor safety.

At completion say: “The search task is complete. Please stop turning. We will finish the questions about this block, then I will help you remove the headset.”

Say: “These questions ask about your workload, your experience of the activity and the voice assistant. There are no right answers. Please answer based on the block you just finished.”

ACTION: Administer Survey Block #2.

9 Final Qualtrics

Say: “Please complete the final questionnaire. It asks about your experiences with the two voices. It is fine to have no preference. We are interested in what you experienced, including anything distracting, uncomfortable or unhelpful.”

Say: “Some follow-up questions may appear depending on your answers and the timing condition you experienced. Answer based on your own experience and tell me when you have submitted it.”

Exploratory follow-up: After open responses, ask “Did either voice feel like your own thoughts, like another person helping, or neither?” Record this as an exploratory report, not proof of an internal-dialogue mechanism.

ACTION: Survey Block #3 + post-study questions.

10 Debrief and finish

Say: “Thank you. This study compares generic and self-similar voices during gaze-guided object search. Both voices provide gaze-contingent assistance. We are examining task performance and how participants experience the activity and assistant.”

Say: “Your data are stored under a coded participant ID. Please avoid discussing the timing condition or study details with people who may participate later, because knowing them in advance could affect their behavior.”

Ask: “Do you have any questions about the study or your experience?”

Say: “Thank you for participating. We are finished.”

Immediate stop or pause criteria

PAUSE OR STOP: Participant request, dizziness, nausea, headache, eye strain, fatigue, pain, distress, unsafe movement or equipment failure. Help the participant remain seated and remove the headset when needed.

ACTION: Pause through the verified researcher control; the beta supports P on a connected keyboard and Trigger / Enter at its resume checkpoint. App focus loss can pause or technically stop a session. Log time, trial, reason and outcome. Resume only when the participant wants to continue and tracking/audio/alignment are valid; otherwise stop and preserve partial data.

Final researcher check

- Confirm both block surveys and final interview/symptom records, or record why incomplete. Match participant, run, block and voice identifiers.
- Verify MotionData and AttemptData for all three blocks.
- Secure data and sanitize equipment.

Appendix Current recording passage

“Locate the red sphere. Look toward the upper shelf. Move your gaze slowly to the right. Check the blue cube near the center. Compare each object’s color and shape. Scan the lower row from left to right. Look beside the purple cylinder. Focus on the target and hold your gaze steady. Select the matching object. Take a short pause. Get ready for the next round.”